

what; I still could not seem to save "enough". Where was all the money going? What was happening? I had a better car, better house, and better furniture but why was I not as happy as I was when I was younger? Where had my happiness gone? How long could I continue to do this? What if something happened to me and I was out of work for a few months? How would my family survive? Why was I still struggling to survive after so many years of a "successful" career? How would I ever be able to get out of this trap and even think about my life goals – goals that go beyond the six individuals in my family?

As all these questions were haunting me, I realized that the first logical step to achieving my true life goals had to be evading this trap of earning money. There had to be a way. And once I was out of this trap, then I could truly pursue the other cherished goals of my life. Life without these goals, I strongly believed, would only end in frustration and unfulfilled desires.

This book takes you through the journey of how I managed to break free from this trap and became a financially free³ individual. It documents all my learning and experience during this beautiful journey. Only 1% of the people in the world are successfully able to finish this journey and I know I am one of those special ones. Is this journey difficult? Is it technical? Does it need special skills and knowledge to go through the journey? Do you need to be lucky to get through to the end of this journey? Do you need any specialized financial degrees?

You will realize while reading this book that the answer to all these questions is a resounding "No". All these things may give you an edge at some stage of this journey but they are neither mandatory nor do they guarantee successful completion of the journey. Then what is it that makes 99% of us unsuccessful and only 1% successful in this journey of financial freedom? As with most great things in life, the answer is a set of very simple steps and changes in some habits that we all need to bring about in ourselves to be able to break this deadly trap. Was it easy? No. It is never easy to change yourself and my case was no different. Was it worth it? Absolutely, it was.

It took me 7 years from the day I initiated a financial freedom plan to reach close to financial freedom but each learning, every change, every sacrifice was worth its weight in gold, or even diamonds! Today, I am not